

CDN Incident Alert: 0053. TLP: CLEAR			Date
Title	DE	Russian Blog-post discrediting German politicians localized for German Audiences	25/02/2025

Summary

- On February 20th, an article by a Russian blogger discrediting Scholz and Merz and featured a manipulated image of German chancellor candidates' campaign posters, was translated and republished by the X and Telegram accounts @Unikat510.
- The post promotes a narrative that German politicians are untrustworthy, encouraging political distrust.
- The posts reach was very limited, but this incident aims to highlight this specific pattern of behavior.
- The post includes a link to a Telegram channel, leading users to a less moderated information space.
- The incident highlights how Russian-language content is being localized for German audiences by anonymous Telegram channels.
- Further research and monitoring should be done to identify how Russian content is brought into the German information space.

Incident

On the 20th of February, the dzen.ru user “Колючие новости” published a Russian-language article referencing a survey claiming that almost half of Germany think Olaf Scholz and Friedrich Merz are untrustworthy (1). On the same day, the dzen.ru user's Telegram channel @ezhevesti posted a link to the article together with a digitally defaced image of Olaf Scholz and Friedrich Merz campaign posters, saying nonsense and lie (2). On the next day, the Telegram post was translated and first posted on the Telegram channel @defreundschaftu before being shared on the X account @Unikat510 (3, 4). The X post contained a link to the Telegram channel, encouraging users to read more on their Telegram channel. This incident demonstrate how content from the Russian information space is translated and inserted into the German information space and try to drive users onto Telegram.

Narrative

Meta narrative: Political leaders are dishonest and do not act in the interests of the people.

Sub-narratives: German politicians lie to the public; Elections are manipulated through false promises; To improve German's security situation, Germany needs to build relations with Putin.

Impact

Reach: The content received 8794 views, 25 likes, 10 shares, and 2 comments.

Outcome: Possible migration of users to Telegram for further disinformation exposure.

Key Objectives and Behaviours (DISARM Red Framework)

Objective: [Subvert](#) - Undermine trust in democratic processes.

- [Create Localised Content](#) – The account is translating content from Russian to German.
- [Direct Users to Alternative Platforms](#) – The account is driving users to their Telegram channel.
- [Deceptively Edit Images \(Cheap Fakes\)](#) – Edited an image to make it look like campaign posters were graffitied.
- [Use Pseudonyms](#) – The users are all hiding their identity.

Recommendations and Actions Taken

Action taken: Incident logged for monitoring and saved for aggregation.

Recommendations: Monitor the Telegram channel for further disinformation narratives; Research how narratives from the Russian information space travels to the German information space.

Report	Topic	Evidence	Authors	Platforms	Logo
N/A	German Elections	In Alert	Konstantinos Margaros, Kemea Research. Saman Nazari, Alliance4Europe.	X	